



Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters received from readers on these pages.

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Inbox

add that even though urban and semi-urban centres in India (even rural, for that matter) have caught the mobile fever, there are still a few who stubbornly do not use cell phones. And these primarily include celebrities.

They may have their own reasons (or do they want to show-off?) for not carrying a cell phone, but I guess the market hasn't suffered from such anti-cell propaganda since this technology propagates something that we all need: communication. It's this very need that mankind has felt since time immemorial and the cell fulfills that in as small a form as it can get!

Thank you, Digit, for reminding us of this fundamental need.

Meera Jain
via e-mail

Love us? Hate us? Tell us!

Dear Reader,

The September pages of Inbox will be dedicated to your opinion of the new Digit. Did you like the new features? Did you like its people-centric approach? What do you feel of the all new sections? Did you love the DVD, or did you hate it?

No matter what you feel or opine, tell us. We would love to hear from you. Write to us at editor@thinkdigit.com

Executive Editor

Asking for a balance

Your July issue was quite busy—full of articles that were of real value to the average reader rather than just concentrating on just hardware and software reviews.

Just when it was time for everyone to file their tax returns, you came up with a review of accounting and taxation software, which was refreshingly welcome. Even the article on IT jobs was good, but it needed a lot more inputs about personal experiences from job seekers, to be able to cover both angles in entirety. Perhaps space constraints caused you to commit the lesser of the two evils, as improper coverage of the employers' perspective would just be criminal.

The 'Tips & Tricks' on Easter Eggs

was 100 per cent entertaining, and 0 per cent beneficial—make that 50-50 at least the next time. For a gamer like me, the layout of the 'Game Cheats' section was confusing. The white boxes all over the place with text on a green background made for some terrible reading.

Warren Dias
Delhi

Usability is important too

Thank you for the special section on cell phones in the July issue, particularly smart phones.

But I think usability is a key criterion while purchasing cell phones. The 'eye-shaped' Nokia 7600, for example, has a radical design, but I am not sure how comfortable it would be



to handle and use everyday, even for people who can afford the handset.

It seems to me that designers should not compromise on usability just to catch the customer's eye.

Saket Sharma
Via e-mail



Goof ups

On Page 134 of the July 2004 issue, in the review of College Pro Science CD, you have mentioned two prices for the same product—Rs 1,350 and Rs 1,995. So which one is correct?

Sachin Sharma

Dear Sachin,
The exact price of College Science Pro is Rs 1,350. We apologise for the error.

Notice any **goof-ups**?
Write to goof@jasubhai.com

Just do it

Vipul Shah's column in the July 2004 issue of *Digit* ('Dear minister, Lend Me An Ear') was well timed. As a nation though, we are already late. Our illogical duties and exorbitant bandwidth prices have done their bit to stunt the growth of the Internet in particular, and information technology in general.

Shah's column article stokes a passionate issue for any serious Internet user or enthusiast. Indians don't realise this until their chat buddies abroad tell you about their 512 Kbps and 1.5 Mbps Internet connections (512 K has almost become the standard speed for any casual broadband connection abroad). So much so that broadband seems to be a misnomer in India.

Moreover, ISPs are poorly configured. You can very well surf the Internet, but try doing something a bit more advanced like running a SHOUTcast server from your desktop, or using a P2P application, and you will usually find yourself behind a restrictive firewall or a Network Address Translator (NAT). Port forwarding is a solution, but your cablewallah administrator is either too reluctant to configure that for you, or just does not know how to do it.

Quality of Service is a term they have never heard of. Be it cellular operators or ISPs, there's no bottom limit to how much their services might degrade. They usually fix it sooner or later but ideally, a customer should be compensated for any sub-standard service meted out to him.

A common argument is that Chandrababu Naidu lost the state elections in Andhra Pradesh because he ignored basic needs of the people, especially the poor and agricultural class, at the cost of technological advancement. Maybe so. My point is that while a minister need not be saturated with IT-promoting ambitions, each minister in key positions should have an understanding of the importance of IT and how we lag in certain aspects plainly because of archaic policies.

Other Asian countries are already ahead of us. We cannot wait any longer. No Sir! We have to start now.

Yuvan Sankrityayan

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH